# The Family Money Meeting Kit

## Stop Fighting About Money in 4 Weeks

*A fill-in-the-blank system for couples — not a book about budgeting.*

| Partner A name: | Partner B name: |
| --- | --- |
| Money role (circle one): **Spender \| Saver \| Avoider \| Planner** | Money role (circle one): **Spender \| Saver \| Avoider \| Planner** |

| Our shared financial goal: | Weekly meeting time: |
| --- | --- |

# Page 1 — Why you're here

**Read this page together before anything else. Out loud if you can.**

Money fights are almost never about money.

They are about feeling unheard. About different ideas of what safety means. About one person carrying a mental load the other doesn't see. About fear dressed up as a disagreement over takeout.

This kit is not a budgeting course. It will not lecture you about lattes or tell you to track 47 categories. It is a communication system — a set of structured tools that give you and your partner a shared language for money, a weekly ritual that replaces arguments with decisions, and scripts for the moments when it gets hard.

**Three things this kit promises:**

- A 20-minute weekly meeting habit you will actually keep.
- At least one shared goal you both care about.
- Scripts for your specific recurring fight — so you stop having it the same way.

The only rule: you are on the same team. You are not trying to win the conversation. You are trying to build a life together.

**OUR COMMITMENT (BOTH SIGN):**

*Partner A signature:* _____

*Partner B signature:* _____

## Page 2 — Your money dynamic

Each partner circles their money role below. Then look up your pairing in the table.

| Spender | Saver | Avoider | Planner |
|---|---|---|---|
| Energised by spending. Struggles with saving as a concept. | Energised by accumulating. Struggles with enjoying now. | Avoids money stress by not looking. Creates bigger problems. | Energised by control. Struggles when reality breaks the plan. |

**OUR PAIRING:**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Our dynamic label** | *e.g. Spender + Planner: The Classic Tension* |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Why we fight** | *e.g. One partner sees overspending, the other feels controlled.* |

**OUR #1 RECURRING ARGUMENT:**

*Write the fight you keep having in one sentence:*

**Common pairings and their tension:**

- Spender + Planner — freedom vs control. One wants permission, the other wants predictability.
- Saver + Spender — scarcity vs abundance mindset. One hoards, the other resents it.
- Avoider + Planner — one avoids the numbers, the other carries all the mental load.
- Two Avoiders — neither one looks. Bills get missed. Resentment builds quietly.
- Two Planners — the fight is about whose plan is right, not whether to plan.

# Page 3 — Values alignment exercise

**Do this independently first — no discussing. Then compare and circle the gaps.**

Score each value 1 (not important to me) to 10 (deeply important). Be honest, not aspirational.

| Value | Partner A (1–10) | Partner B (1–10) |
|---|---|---|
| Security — having a safety net, no financial surprises | | |
| Freedom — ability to spend without asking or justifying | _____ | _____ |
| Experiences — travel, events, memories over things | _____ | _____ |
| Status — living in a way that reflects success | _____ | _____ |
| Generosity — giving to others, causes, family | _____ | _____ |
| Growth — investing in future self, education, career | _____ | _____ |
| Simplicity — low overhead, less stuff, less stress | _____ | _____ |
| Adventure — taking financial risks for big rewards | _____ | _____ |
| Stability — predictable income, steady savings, no debt | _____ | _____ |
| Comfort — quality of daily life, nice home, good food | _____ | _____ |

**AFTER COMPARING:**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Values we agree on (gap of 2 or less)** | |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Values we differ on most** | |

**What your gaps mean:**

- A gap of 3+ is normal. It does not mean you are incompatible. It means you need a system that honours both values.
- The most common tension: one partner scores Security high, the other scores Freedom high. This is the root of almost every money fight.
- Use the values with the biggest gaps as discussion topics in your first meeting.

# Page 4 — Shared goal + responsibility map

## Part A — Your shared goal card

**Our #1 shared financial goal:**

*e.g. Save $8,000 for a house down payment by December*

**Monthly savings needed to hit it:**

*Total amount ÷ months remaining = $ _____ per month*

**Why this goal matters to both of us:**

## Part B — Responsibility map

Write in who currently handles each area. Mark gaps and overlaps honestly.

| Category | Currently handled by | Change needed? |
|---|---|---|
| Paying rent / mortgage | | |
| Paying utilities + subscriptions | | |
| Grocery + household spending | | |
| Tracking monthly spending | | |
| Managing savings / investments | | |
| Filing taxes | | |
| Day-to-day cash decisions | | |
| Emergency fund contributions | | |

**WHAT TO DISCUSS IN MEETING ONE:**

# Page 5 — The 20-minute weekly meeting agenda

**This is the heart of the kit. Run this every week. No prep needed — just show up and follow the timer.**

**Before you start:**

- Sit next to each other, not across. Phones face-down.
- No other agenda. No parenting, no logistics. Just this.
- If you feel tension rising, say: “Let’s put that in the parking lot.” Write it down and move on.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Block 1 \| 2 min**<br>**Check-in** | One word each: how are you feeling about money this week? No explanation required.<br>**Notes:** |
| **Block 2 \| 5 min**<br>**Last week review** | Did we stick to our spending intentions? Any surprises? No blame — just facts.<br>**Notes:** |
| **Block 3 \| 5 min**<br>**Goal progress** | Where are we toward: _____ (fill in your goal)? What moved the needle this week?<br>**Notes:** |
| **Block 4 \| 5 min**<br>**This week’s decisions** | What money decisions are coming up? Who is handling what? Any category to watch?<br>**Notes:** |
| **Block 5 \| 3 min**<br>**Appreciation** | Each partner names one thing the other did well with money this week. End here. Always.<br>**Notes:** |

# Page 6 — The argument script library

**Pull this page out when a fight starts. Find your situation. Use the reframe, not your instinct.**

*Your recurring fight is highlighted on the cover. Start there.*

## Fight 1 — Overspending on non-essentials

**Partner A says:**

*"You spent how much on that? We said we were saving."*

**Partner B reframes:**

*"I hear you want us to save more. I want that too. Can we talk about what amount feels reasonable for personal spending so neither of us feels monitored?"*

**Neutral pivot question:**

*"What monthly amount, set aside in advance for each of us to spend freely, would make this argument unnecessary?"*

**Our version of this fight:**

**What we agreed:**

## Fight 2 — Secret or hidden purchases

**Partner A says:**

*"Why didn't you tell me about that? I feel like I can't trust what's in our account."*

**Partner B reframes:**

*"I should have told you. I think I hid it because I was afraid of your reaction. Can we talk about what kind of purchases need checking in vs what's just mine to decide?"*

**Neutral pivot question:**

*"What's a dollar threshold where we agree to tell each other before buying, no questions asked?"*

**Our version of this fight:**

**What we agreed:**

## Fight 3 — Income imbalance tension

**Partner A says:**

*"I earn more but I feel like I have no more say. That doesn't seem fair."*

**Partner B reframes:**

*"I don't want you to feel like your contribution doesn't count. I want us to decide together. What would make this feel more equal to you?"*

**Neutral pivot question:**

*"What would a fair system look like where income difference doesn't affect who has more voice in money decisions?"*

**Our version of this fight:**

**What we agreed:**

## Fight 4 — Different savings urgency

**Partner A says:**

*"We need to save more. I feel like you don't take this seriously."*

**Partner B reframes:**

*"I do want us to be secure. I think I'm less anxious about it than you are, which I know can feel like I don't care. What specific number would make you feel safe?"*

**Neutral pivot question:**

*"If we hit $_____ in savings, would you feel less anxious about spending in other areas?"*

**Our version of this fight:**

**What we agreed:**

## Fight 5 — One partner avoids money conversations

**Partner A says:**

*"You never want to talk about this. I end up handling everything alone and it's exhausting."*

**Partner B reframes:**

*"I know I check out. It's not that I don't care — it's that I feel overwhelmed and don't know what to do with the information. What's the smallest version of this conversation I could actually handle?"*

**Neutral pivot question:**

*"What's one specific thing you need me to be involved in that would feel like meaningful help to you?"*

**Our version of this fight:**

**What we agreed:**

# Page 7 — 4-week habit tracker + week 5 bridge

**One row per week. Fill it in together at the end of each meeting. Four completions = a proven habit.**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Our meeting day + time** | _____ every week |

| Week | Date | Topics we covered | One win | One to improve |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Week 1** | | | | |
| **Week 2** | | | | |
| **Week 3** | | | | |
| **Week 4** | | | | |

## Week 5 bridge — evolving your meetings

After 4 weeks your meetings will feel different. Here is how to evolve them so they stay useful.

| | |
|---|---|
| **If meetings feel too long** | Drop Block 2 (review). Keep Blocks 3, 4, and 5. 12 minutes is fine. |
| **If one partner still checks out** | Shorten to 10 minutes. Only cover goal progress and one decision. Build from there. |
| **If you want to go deeper** | Add a monthly “big picture” meeting (45 min) to review the month and set next month’s intentions. |

## You did it.

Four meetings. Four weeks. One habit that will outlast any budget app.

*Money is not the hard part. Communication is. You just got better at the hard part.*